ROOMIE MANILA

Product Requirements Document

User-testing-aligned MVP revision

Make Metro Manila's fragmented rental market structured, transparent, and trustworthy - so a renter can confidently contact a host and schedule a viewing.

Document	Definition
Authors	Tae Jun TJ Cha and Takashi Ban
Revision	2.0 - revised from the March 11, 2026 BahayTrust PRD
Date	November 8, 2026
Market	Metro Manila rental housing
Primary users	Renters and hosts/property managers
Product stage	Validated interactive prototypes; production capabilities remain to be built

EVIDENCE BASE

This revision synthesizes the original PRD, Roomie Manila User Testing Readout (August 2026), User Test Analysis (Screen Recordings), and the tenant and host prototypes in the mvproomie repository.

Decision status

Approved direction for the next product iteration. Numerical findings are directional because the study included 15 participants and each tenant MVP had four testers.

SECTION 00

Executive summary

A narrower, evidence-led product definition for Roomie Manila.

Trust is the product. Search is the entry point. A confident contact or viewing request is the first meaningful outcome.

What changed from the prior PRD

- Replaced the broad BahayTrust real-estate infrastructure concept with a focused Metro Manila rental marketplace.
- Reduced primary audiences from renters, buyers, sellers, investors, brokers, and administrators to renters and hosts/property managers.
- Moved ownership registries, escrow, AI valuation, investor analytics, loan tools, blockchain, and institutional dashboards out of the next MVP.
- Made verified identity/listings, transparent pricing, authentic photos, reviews, and explainable Roomie Scores the P0 trust layer.
- Made occupancy, roommate context, lease terms, fees, and commute/neighborhood context required listing information rather than optional enrichment.
- Selected tenant MVP2's split map/list interaction as the working usability baseline, informed by its directional SUS result of 80.6.

Product decision

Build the smallest credible path from discovery to verified contact: discover -> filter -> inspect listing -> establish trust -> understand location and lifestyle -> contact host -> schedule viewing. Payments and services follow only after Roomie can consistently support this path.

Release definition

Now: next validated MVP	Next: transaction readiness	Later: marketplace expansion
Verified profiles and listings; complete listing data; map/list discovery; reviews; explainable Roomie Score; messaging; viewing requests; reporting/moderation.	Documents and contracts; payment tracking; receipts; optional escrow pilot; operational notifications.	Ancillary services; roommate matching/feed; deeper market tools; institutional integrations.

SECTION 01

What the research says

Findings are translated into product decisions, not merely repeated.

74.2
Average SUS across 15 participants

80.6
Tenant MVP2 SUS, n=4

60%
Ranked Trust and Safety first

3.73/4
Average recommendation rating

Evidence	Interpretation	Requirement consequence
9 of 15 ranked Trust and Safety #1	Trust is not a support feature; it is the core value proposition.	P0 verification, reviews, photo integrity, transparent pricing, score explainability, and reporting.
14 of 15 found listing details broadly clear	The visual foundation works, but confidence depends on missing decision-critical fields.	Keep the clean detail layout; add occupancy, roommates, lease, fees, availability, building, and document fields.
MVP2 SUS 80.6 vs. 70.6 for MVP1 and MVP3	The split map/list pattern is the strongest directional starting point, not a statistically proven winner.	Use MVP2 as baseline; retain MVP1's map synchronization and MVP3's curated rails as secondary patterns.
Facebook is the main alternative	Roomie cannot win on network size initially; it can win on structure, verification, and decision quality.	Standardize listing data, clarify verification, preserve local context, and make safety signals visible.
Payments were valued, especially by hosts	Transaction tools have pull, but users first need confidence in people and properties.	Sequence Discovery -> Verification -> Communication -> Documentation -> Payments.
Screen recordings exposed navigation and sorting gaps	Small flow defects can undermine an otherwise credible service.	Return users to the originating listing after chat; add price/relevance sort; clarify icons and onboarding.

Research caveat

The sample supports prioritization and hypothesis formation, not population estimates. The next round must compare the same tasks across variants and measure confidence to contact, task success, time, and comprehension of trust signals.

SECTION 02

Product definition

Who Roomie serves, what problem it solves, and what it will not attempt yet.

Problem statement

Metro Manila renters often search through fragmented, inconsistently structured listings where host identity, price, occupancy, photos, lease terms, and location context are difficult to verify. Hosts manage inquiries, viewings, tenants, and payments across disconnected tools. Both sides lack a shared, credible record of the people, property, and transaction context.

Product vision

Roomie is the trusted rental layer for Metro Manila: a structured marketplace where credible people and properties are easy to understand, compare, contact, and manage.

Primary jobs to be done

User	Job	Successful outcome
Renter	When I need housing, help me find realistic options near my daily destinations and understand who and what I can trust.	I confidently contact a verified host or request a viewing for a listing whose full cost and living situation I understand.
Host/property manager	When I have an available unit, help me present it credibly and manage qualified interest without fragmented chat and spreadsheets.	I publish a complete verified listing, respond to qualified inquiries, schedule viewings, and maintain an auditable status trail.

Design principles

- Evidence before assertion: every trust badge must state what was checked, when, and by whom.
- Complete before clever: required rental facts outrank AI features or decorative personalization.
- Local context is core product data: commute, transit, flood/traffic, and daily needs shape housing decisions.
- Progressive commitment: browsing can be light-friction; identity checks increase before messaging, viewing, contracting, and payments.
- Human recourse: users can report, appeal, correct, and understand decisions that affect visibility or trust status.

SECTION 03

Users and scenarios

Two primary users, with differences handled through context rather than persona sprawl.

User segment	Needs	Current pain	Roomie promise
Student or student-worker renter	Affordability, transit, safety, roommate fit, flexible viewing.	Facebook posts lack consistency; budget listings may omit occupancy, fees, or current photos.	Comparable listings, verified signals, commute context, and roommate/occupancy visibility.
Early-career renter	Commute reliability, complete monthly cost, privacy, responsive host.	Hard to compare tradeoffs across neighborhoods and detect misleading listings.	Structured search, transparent cost, map intelligence, verified host, reviews, and viewing workflow.
Small landlord or property host	Credible presentation, qualified leads, low-friction scheduling, status tracking.	Repeated questions, scattered messages, weak differentiation from fraudulent posts.	Verification, complete listing template, inquiries, calendar, tenant profiles, and trust-building history.
Property manager	Portfolio visibility, repeatable workflows, response and payment records.	Units, conversations, tenants, and collections live in separate tools.	Dashboard, listing states, inquiry pipeline, scheduled viewings, and later payment operations.

Critical scenarios

- A renter filters by budget, unit type, and commute, then compares total monthly cost and occupancy across results.
- A renter opens a listing, understands verification and score evidence, checks authentic photos and reviews, then requests a viewing.
- A host creates a listing and cannot publish until required facts, fees, availability, and photo freshness are complete.
- A host receives an inquiry tied to a listing, reviews the renter's disclosed profile, replies, and schedules a viewing.
- Either side reports misleading information or unsafe behavior and receives a traceable resolution state.

Access and inclusion

The product must support low-bandwidth mobile use, clear English, and architecture ready for Filipino localization. Verification must offer alternative evidence paths for users without a single preferred document and must never expose sensitive documents to counterparties.

SECTION 04

Experience architecture

The product is organized around a confidence-building journey.

Stage	User question	Required product response	Exit signal
1. Discover	Are there plausible options for me?	Map/list results, price and relevance sort, curated local rails, saved search.	Opens a relevant listing.
2. Filter	Does it fit my constraints?	Budget, type, furnished, Wi-Fi, occupancy, availability, lease length, commute.	Shortlist is manageable.
3. Inspect	What exactly am I getting and paying?	Structured facts, current photos, total cost, fees, rules, amenities, roommates.	No critical unanswered fact.
4. Establish trust	Are this person and property credible?	Verification evidence, reviews, score explanation, report pathway, freshness dates.	Trust confidence threshold met.
5. Understand place	Can I live my daily life here?	Commute estimates, transit, groceries, landmarks, safety/environment notes.	Location tradeoffs understood.
6. Contact	Can I take the next step safely?	Listing-linked chat, contact context, viewing request and scheduling.	Qualified contact or scheduled viewing.

Navigation model

Tenant: Home/Search, Saved, Inbox, Profile. Host: Dashboard, Listings, Tenants, Inquiries, Payments, Profile. Mode switching may remain in Profile, but each mode must preserve independent state and clear role labeling.

Flow rules

- Every conversation remains visibly linked to its originating listing and preserves a return-to-listing action.
- Map pins, list cards, and selected listing state remain synchronized.
- Back navigation returns to prior search position, filters, and scroll state.
- Contact and viewing calls to action show the trust state of both parties before commitment.
- Incomplete, stale, paused, rented, or disputed listings cannot silently appear as active inventory.

SECTION 05

MVP prototype decision

How the six current prototype routes inform the next integrated iteration.

Prototype	Observed/current strength	Decision
Tenant MVP1	Map-first search with synchronized listing carousel.	Retain synchronization and fast spatial scanning as an optional map emphasis mode.
Tenant MVP2	Split map/list with draggable sheet; strongest directional usability result (SUS 80.6, n=4).	Use as the primary mobile discovery baseline for the next test.
Tenant MVP3	Curated neighborhood, budget, and size rails.	Retain rails as secondary discovery modules, not the primary navigation.
Shared tenant flows	Detail, saved, inbox/chat, profile, map, host peek, verification and Roomie Score concepts.	Keep, then add missing trust explanation, full listing facts, sort, location context, and navigation continuity.
Host MVP1/2/3	Dashboard, listing CRUD/status, tenant/inquiry views, chat, viewing calendar, payments, reviews, profile.	Consolidate into one host workflow; prioritize listing quality and inquiry/viewing operations before live payments.

Current implementation boundary

The mvproomie codebase is an interactive front-end prototype with mock state and data. It demonstrates flows and interaction patterns; it does not prove production authentication, verification, moderation, payments, privacy controls, or persistent marketplace operations.

Next prototype objective

Create one integrated tenant variant and one integrated host variant that test the trust-to-contact journey end to end. Avoid adding more surface area until participants can accurately interpret verification, total cost, occupancy, location tradeoffs, and the Roomie Score.

SECTION 06

Scope and priority

Priority reflects user evidence, risk reduction, and sequence dependencies.

Priority	Included capabilities
P0 - must validate	Identity and host verification; listing/property evidence; authentic/current photos; full price/fees; availability; occupancy/roommates; lease terms; reviews; explainable Roomie Score; report/moderation; listing-linked chat; viewing request.
P1 - should validate	MVP2 discovery baseline; price/relevance sort; commute and transit; nearby daily needs; traffic/flood context; host listing quality meter; notifications; navigation continuity; saved search; document readiness.
P2 - after trust	Payment status and receipts; escrow pilot; contracts/e-signature; roommate matching/feed; cleaning, utilities, legal, moving, repairs, furniture; richer analytics.
Out of next MVP	Property sales, investor personas, AI valuation, loan simulation, blockchain/immutable ledger claims, FX, institutional dashboards, registry automation, insurance marketplace.

Release gates

Gate	Minimum evidence to proceed
Trust comprehension	At least 80% of test participants correctly explain each badge and Roomie Score components without moderator help.
Listing decision quality	At least 80% correctly identify total move-in cost, monthly cost, occupancy, lease duration, and availability.
Contact confidence	At least 70% report high confidence (4 or 5 of 5) before contacting a verified host in the tested scenario.
Core usability	At least 90% complete search -> listing -> contact/viewing without a critical error; target SUS >= 80 for the integrated prototype.
Safety readiness	Reporting, moderation ownership, evidence retention, appeals, and emergency escalation policies are defined and exercised in a tabletop test.

SECTION 07

Trust, verification, and safety

Trust signals must be specific, current, explainable, and contestable.

ID	Capability	Acceptance requirement
TR-01	Identity verification	Show Verified identity only after approved identity evidence and liveness/manual checks. Counterparties see status and verification date, never raw documents.
TR-02	Host authority	Distinguish owner, authorized representative, broker, and property manager. Display the asserted role and evidence status.
TR-03	Listing verification	Record property/address evidence, review status, reviewer type, and last verified date. Badge wording must match the actual check.
TR-04	Photo integrity	Require recent photos, captured/uploaded date, minimum coverage, and attestation that images show the current unit. Flag duplicates, AI-generated imagery, or material edits for review.
TR-05	Roomie Score	Display components, weights/ranges, data freshness, missing evidence, and improvement steps. Never present the score as a guarantee of safety or character.
TR-06	Reviews	Only eligible interactions can create reviews. Separate host, tenant, and listing feedback; show date and verified-interaction status; provide dispute process.
TR-07	Reporting	Permit reports from listing, profile, and conversation. Confirm receipt, assign severity, preserve evidence, communicate status, and protect reporters from retaliation.
TR-08	Moderation	Support pause, removal, warning, verification hold, and account restriction with reason codes, audit trail, and appeal workflow.

Score safeguards

- Use only product-relevant evidence such as verification, listing completeness/freshness, response reliability, and verified-interaction history.
- Do not use protected traits, proxies for socioeconomic status, unverified social media, or inferred criminality.
- Do not collapse a missing-data user into a low-trust user; label evidence as incomplete and offer alternative verification paths.
- Log score changes and expose a plain-language explanation and correction/appeal route.

SECTION 08

Listing quality requirements

A listing is publishable only when it supports an informed rental decision.

Field group	Required data
Identity and status	Listing ID; host role; verification state/date; active/draft/paused/rented/disputed; available-from date; last updated.
Property	Exact or privacy-safe location; unit/property type; building name/age where applicable; floor; size; bedrooms; bathrooms; furnishing; accessibility.
Occupancy	Capacity; current occupants; available slots; private/shared room; roommate count; optional disclosed lifestyle attributes; guest/pet/smoking rules.
Price	Base rent; association dues; utilities included/excluded; recurring fees; deposits; advance rent; application/admin fees; estimated move-in total.
Lease	Minimum/maximum duration; renewal; termination; required documents; payment schedule; house rules; contract availability.
Amenities	Wi-Fi; air conditioning; laundry; kitchen; parking; security; elevator; backup power/water; shared facilities.
Media	Current, authentic photos covering sleeping area, bathroom, kitchen/shared areas, exterior/building access, and material defects; capture/upload dates.
Location	Map; commute destinations; transit stops; groceries and essentials; school/work landmarks; traffic/flood notes; neighborhood context.

Listing behavior

- Show both monthly recurring cost and estimated move-in cost near the primary call to action.
- Indicate missing or unverified facts; do not infer them from photos or host text.
- Block publish when required fields or minimum photo coverage are absent.
- Prompt reconfirmation at defined freshness intervals and whenever availability, price, occupancy, or host authority changes.
- Allow users to compare selected listings across cost, occupancy, lease, trust, and commute dimensions.

SECTION 09

Discovery and Metro Manila intelligence

Search should reduce uncertainty, not simply produce more inventory.

ID	Capability	Acceptance requirement
DS-01	Search and filter	Budget; total monthly cost; type; furnished; Wi-Fi; occupancy; private/shared; availability; lease length; verified only; commute threshold.
DS-02	Sort	Price low/high, relevance, newest, commute, and trust evidence. Explain relevance at a high level.
DS-03	Map/list sync	Selecting a pin highlights the card; selecting a card centers/highlights the pin; sheet and map preserve context.
DS-04	Curated discovery	Neighborhood, price, and size rails may supplement search. Labels must state selection logic and never imply paid ranking without disclosure.
LI-01	Commute	Allow at least one school/work destination; show mode, estimated typical time/range, distance, and data timestamp.
LI-02	Transit and essentials	Show nearby rail/bus/jeepney access where data permits, plus groceries, pharmacies, clinics, and other daily needs.
LI-03	Environment	Present available flood/traffic/building context with source and update date; avoid categorical safety guarantees.
LI-04	Neighborhood view	Provide map/street context and host-supplied local notes clearly separated from platform-verified data.

Ranking guardrails

Ranking may use query fit, verified availability, listing completeness/freshness, distance/commute, responsiveness, and verified-interaction quality. Paid promotion, if introduced, must be labeled and must not override safety holds or required completeness.

SECTION 10

Communication and host operations

The next MVP closes the loop from credible listing to managed viewing.

ID	Capability	Acceptance requirement
CM-01	Listing-linked inquiry	Start chat from a listing; retain listing snapshot, price/status, and return link in the thread.
CM-02	Safe contact	Mask personal contact by default; show verification states; detect/report prohibited or abusive content; provide block controls.
CM-03	Viewing request	Renter proposes times; host confirms/reschedules; both see status and reminders; cancellation retains history.
CM-04	Context continuity	Closing chat returns to the originating listing or preserved prior screen, never an unrelated default view.
HO-01	Listing workflow	Create/edit/preview/publish/pause/mark rented; show completeness and verification blockers before publish.
HO-02	Inquiry pipeline	New, replied, viewing, approved/declined, closed; filters and unread state; response-time metrics.
HO-03	Viewing calendar	Calendar and list views; conflict warning; reminders; listing and renter context available from each event.
HO-04	Tenant context	Show only renter data intentionally disclosed for the housing interaction; verification and reviews are explainable and appealable.
HO-05	Dashboard	Active units, new inquiries, upcoming viewings, listing issues, and response tasks. Payment summaries remain prototype-only until transaction phase.

Anti-discrimination requirement

Roommate and tenant profiles must not become a screening mechanism for unlawful or harmful discrimination. Product counsel and local policy review must define permitted criteria, prohibited targeting, enforcement, and user recourse before production launch.

SECTION 11

Documents, payments, and services

Valuable, but sequenced after trust and listing quality.

Phase	Capability	Conditions
A. Documentation readiness	Lease templates/checklists, document request status, secure exchange, version history, acceptance records.	Legal review; data retention and access policy; clear distinction between platform tools and legal advice.
B. Payment operations	Paid/unpaid status, reminders, ledger, receipts/invoices, method and date, export.	Persistent accounts; reconciliation; dispute process; financial data security; host pilot.
C. Payment processing	Rent/deposit collection and optional escrow-like workflow.	Licensed partners, regulatory analysis, consumer disclosures, refunds, chargebacks, settlement, fraud controls, and support readiness.
D. Ancillary services	Cleaning, utilities, legal help, moving, repairs, furniture.	Only after core funnel health; partner quality, pricing, liability, and complaint process defined.

Why this sequence

Testing showed interest in payments, especially from hosts, but trust, listing completeness, and local context were more fundamental. The research also ranked ancillary services behind the housing decision. Roomie should not assume transaction risk before it can reliably establish who is involved, what is being rented, and what was agreed.

Explicit exclusions for the next MVP

- No claims that Roomie holds escrow or guarantees ownership, safety, tenant quality, or legal enforceability.
- No live payment credentials or sensitive document uploads in usability prototypes.
- No automated legal, valuation, loan, or investment advice.
- No service marketplace until the core contact/viewing funnel meets release gates.

SECTION 12

Data, privacy, security, and quality

The product handles sensitive housing, identity, location, and communication data.

ID	Area	Requirement
PR-01	Data minimization	Collect only data required for a stated user or safety purpose; define retention and deletion by data type.
PR-02	Purpose and consent	Explain why identity, location, profile, and document data are used. Separate required processing from optional personalization.
PR-03	User control	Provide access, correction, export, deletion, notification controls, and score/verification appeal where applicable.
SE-01	Access control	Role-based access, least privilege, secure sessions, MFA for privileged staff, and tenant separation.
SE-02	Protection	Encrypt data in transit and at rest; isolate identity documents; prevent raw document access by counterparties.
SE-03	Audit and response	Log privileged actions, verification/moderation changes, and sensitive access; maintain incident triage and notification plan.
Q-01	Performance	Target p75 initial usable mobile view <= 3s on representative Metro Manila mobile conditions; interaction response <= 200ms when local.
Q-02	Reliability	Preserve drafts and messages; idempotent publish/contact actions; visible recovery state; production SLO set after architecture/load tests.
Q-03	Accessibility	Target WCAG 2.2 AA: keyboard use, focus, contrast, labels, error recovery, reduced motion, and non-color status cues.
Q-04	Localization	Externalize copy, currency/date formats, and address conventions; design for English and Filipino without layout breakage.

Production note

The prior PRD's fixed concurrency, latency, and uptime claims should become measured service objectives after backend architecture, vendor dependencies, and launch scale are defined. Prototype responsiveness is not production performance evidence.

SECTION 13

Success metrics and instrumentation

Measure whether Roomie creates informed, safe marketplace progress.

North-star metric: Verified qualified contact rate - the percentage of eligible listing views that lead to a message or viewing request after the renter has seen required cost, occupancy, location, and trust information.

Dimension	Measures
Trust	Verification completion; badge comprehension; Roomie Score comprehension; confidence-to-contact; report rate; substantiated misleading-listing rate.
Listing quality	Required-field completeness; photo freshness; price/fee accuracy; stale availability rate; publish rejection reasons.
Discovery	Search-to-detail rate; useful-result rate; filter use; zero-result rate; shortlist/save; map/list interaction; sort selection.
Conversion	Qualified contact rate; viewing-request rate; host response; scheduled viewing; cancellation/no-show; median time to first response.
Usability	Task completion; critical errors; time on task; backtracking; SUS; support requests; accessibility defects.
Safety guardrails	Reports per interaction; urgent response time; moderation resolution time; appeal overturn rate; repeat offender rate; blocked contact rate.
Supply health	Verified active listings; listings with complete cost/occupancy; geographic coverage; host activation; inventory freshness.

Core event taxonomy

search_submitted, filter_applied, sort_changed, map_pin_selected, listing_viewed, trust_detail_opened, score_explanation_opened, cost_details_opened, listing_saved, inquiry_started, viewing_requested, viewing_scheduled, listing_reported, verification_started/completed, listing_published/paused/rented.

Required event context

Variant, user role, listing state, verification state, score evidence completeness, listing completeness, source screen, search/filter state, anonymized geography, timestamp, and experiment assignment. Do not place raw identity, chat content, or exact home addresses in analytics payloads.

SECTION 14

Next research plan

The next test should resolve product decisions, not simply gather preferences.

Research question	Task/method	Decision rule
Does the integrated MVP2-based discovery flow work?	Find a unit under a set budget near a destination; compare two listings; return after opening chat.	>=90% completion; no critical navigation error; target SUS >=80.
Do users understand trust signals?	Explain identity, listing, host-role badges and Roomie Score; identify what is and is not guaranteed.	>=80% accurate unaided comprehension.
Can users determine true cost and living situation?	State monthly recurring cost, move-in total, occupancy, roommate count, availability, and lease duration.	>=80% correct on all critical facts.
Does location intelligence change decisions?	Choose between cheaper/farther and higher-cost/shorter-commute options; narrate tradeoff.	Users can cite source/timestamp and do not interpret estimates as guarantees.
Can hosts publish credible supply?	Create/publish a listing, fix completeness blockers, respond, and schedule viewing.	>=85% task success; blockers understood without moderator help.
Does trust improve contact intent?	Rate confidence before and after trust/location information and choose whether to contact.	Directional lift with qualitative explanation; avoid claiming causality until larger study.

Sample

Recruit at least 24 participants: renters across student and working segments plus 6-8 active hosts/property managers. Include users who rely on Facebook, lower-bandwidth mobile users, and participants with differing identity-document access. Use the same core tasks across variants.

Study outputs

- Task-level success, error, time, and confidence data; SUS reported with sample size and uncertainty.
- Comprehension failures mapped directly to copy, hierarchy, or policy changes.
- Prioritized issue log with severity, frequency, evidence clips, owner, and retest status.
- Go/no-go recommendation against the release gates in Section 06.

SECTION 15

Roadmap and ownership

A staged plan designed to retire the highest-risk assumptions first.

Stage	Indicative time	Outcome	Primary owners
Stage 0: specification	1-2 weeks	Finalize trust definitions, listing schema, score policy, moderation workflow, research protocol, and instrumentation plan.	Product + Design + Trust/Safety + Legal/Privacy
Stage 1: integrated prototype	2-4 weeks	MVP2-based tenant flow, complete listing detail, trust explanations, local context, listing-linked chat/viewing; consolidated host listing/inquiry flow.	Design + Front-end + Research
Stage 2: validation	2 weeks	24+ participant task study; host workflow tests; accessibility review; safety tabletop; iterate and retest critical failures.	Research + Product + Trust/Safety
Stage 3: pilot build	6-10 weeks	Persistent accounts/data, verification operations, moderation console, notifications, audit logs, analytics, controlled Metro Manila supply onboarding.	Engineering + Operations + Trust/Safety
Stage 4: transaction readiness	After gates	Documents, payment tracking/receipts, regulated partner assessment, limited host pilot.	Product + Finance/Legal + Engineering

Decision checkpoints

- Do not start pilot engineering until trust terminology, listing fields, and moderation ownership are approved.
- Do not process money until partner/regulatory, reconciliation, dispute, refund, and support requirements are signed off.
- Do not add ancillary services while core verified-contact and viewing metrics remain below release gates.
- Do not expand beyond Metro Manila until inventory quality and operations are repeatable in the initial geography.

SECTION 16

Risks, dependencies, and open decisions

The highest risks are operational and institutional, not merely interface-level.

Risk	Severity	Mitigation
False assurance from badges or score	High	Specific labels, evidence/date disclosure, no guarantees, comprehension testing, appeal and incident monitoring.
Discrimination through profiles or ranking	High	Permitted-field policy, protected-trait review, fairness tests, enforcement, recourse, legal review.
Fraud adapts to verification	High	Layered checks, freshness, anomaly review, user reports, holds, repeat-offender controls, human escalation.
Thin verified inventory	High	Start with focused geography/supply partners, assisted onboarding, completeness support, freshness operations.
Location data is stale or misleading	Medium	Source/date labels, ranges, confidence, corrections, avoid safety guarantees.
Operational overload	Medium	Severity queues, service targets, staffing model, escalation playbooks, limited pilot.
Prototype mistaken for production readiness	Medium	Explicit boundary, architecture/security review, persistence and failure testing before pilot.
Payment/regulatory exposure	High	Defer processing; assess licensed partners and obligations before build.

Open decisions requiring owners

- Exact evidence and operations behind each verification badge; owner: Trust/Safety + Legal.
- Roomie Score components, display, thresholds, appeal, and monitoring; owner: Product + Trust/Safety + Data.
- Property address privacy and when exact location is revealed; owner: Product + Privacy.
- Allowed roommate/tenant profile attributes and anti-discrimination controls; owner: Legal/Policy.
- Initial Metro Manila neighborhoods and supply acquisition model; owner: Product + Operations.
- Whether and when to support rent collection or escrow through a partner; owner: Finance/Legal + Product.

SECTION A

Traceability and source notes

Every major change in this revision is tied to evidence or the current prototype.

Decision	Evidence	PRD location
Trust infrastructure is P0	User testing: 9/15 ranked Trust and Safety first; repeated calls for verified hosts/listings, authentic photos, reviews, transparent pricing.	Sections 06-08
MVP2 is discovery baseline	Tenant MVP2 SUS 80.6 vs. 70.6 for MVP1 and MVP3, each n=4; directional only.	Sections 01, 05, 09
Complete occupancy/cost/lease data	Readout and screen recordings: requests for roommates, capacity, full fees, lease terms, availability, and property facts.	Section 08
Metro Manila location intelligence	Requests for commute, transit, nearby needs, Street View/neighborhood, traffic, flood, and building context.	Section 09
Navigation continuity and sort	Screen recordings: chat return issue, listings not sorted by price, inconsistent icons/flow.	Sections 04, 09, 10
Payments follow trust	Payments valued, particularly by hosts, but reports recommend trust/listing/location first and Discovery -> Verification -> Communication -> Documentation -> Payments.	Sections 06, 11
Current MVP boundary	mvproomie repository contains tenant MVP1/2/3 and host MVP1/2/3 React front-end flows with mock data/state.	Section 05
Broad BahayTrust scope removed	Original PRD included sales, investors, AI valuation, loan tools, escrow, blockchain, and institutional analytics beyond validated Roomie rental needs.	Sections 00, 02, 06

Source documents

- (DPI 678M) Product Requirements Document (PRD) by Tae Jun TJ Cha and Takashi Ban (Final).pdf - March 11, 2026, 28 pages.
- Roomie_Manila_User_Testing_Readout_August_2026.pdf - 15-participant usability and preference readout, 8 pages.
- USER TEST ANALYSIS (Screen Recordings).pdf - qualitative synthesis of recorded sessions, 2 pages.
- mvproomie repository at local revision 1fa9bf5f74bebc592dde48a5a7e15a95dfd2f542 - tenant and host MVP routes inspected November 8, 2026.

Interpretation note

This PRD converts research into an implementation and validation sequence. It does not treat small-sample preferences as definitive market demand, nor does it certify legal compliance, safety, ownership, financial regulation, or production readiness.

End state for the next iteration: a renter understands the home, the full cost, the living situation, the location, and the evidence behind trust - then confidently takes the next step.